

ARROGANT

1. Passage anchor

> “She was sharp without being **arrogant**...”

Passage meaning

arrogant = behaving as if you are more important, intelligent, capable, or deserving than other people

傲慢的；自大的；自以為是的

Here, the speaker is praising Ms. Lau for being very intelligent and capable **without** acting superior to others.

Practice

1. She was highly intelligent but never **arrogant**.
她非常聰明，但從不**傲慢**。
2. Confidence is attractive, but it can become unpleasant when it turns **arrogant**.
自信很吸引人，但如果變成**自大**就可能令人反感。

Core meaning of ARROGANT

2. arrogant — believing you are superior to others

= showing an exaggerated sense of your own importance, ability, status, or correctness

傲慢的；自大的；自以為是的

Examples

1. He sounded **arrogant** during the discussion.
他在討論時聽起來很**傲慢**。
2. She is confident, but not **arrogant**.
她有自信，但不**自大**。

This is the central modern meaning.

3. arrogant person

= someone who behaves as though they are better or more important than others

****傲慢的人；自大的人****

Examples

1. Nobody likes working with an ****arrogant person****.

沒有人喜歡和****傲慢的人****共事。

2. He came across as ****arrogant**** even though he was very capable.

雖然他很有能力，但給人的感覺很****自大****。

Arrogant behavior / manner

4. arrogant manner / attitude

= behavior or attitude that suggests superiority

****傲慢的態度；高高在上的態度****

Examples

1. His ****arrogant attitude**** annoyed the team.

他的****傲慢態度****惹惱了團隊。

2. She disliked his ****arrogant manner****.

她不喜歡他那種****高高在上的態度****。

5. arrogant tone

= tone of voice suggesting superiority, dismissal, or contempt

****傲慢的語氣；盛氣凌人的語氣****

Examples

1. He answered in an ****arrogant tone****.

他用****傲慢的語氣****回答。

2. Her comment sounded unnecessarily ****arrogant****.

她的評論聽起來有點不必要地****盛氣凌人****。

Overconfidence / superiority in judgment

6. arrogant assumption

= assumption made with excessive confidence in your own judgment or superiority

****自大的假設；傲慢的想法****

Examples

1. It was ****arrogant**** to assume nobody else understood the problem.
認為別人都不懂這個問題，是很****自大的想法****。
2. The claim rested on an ****arrogant assumption**** that his approach was automatically best.
這個說法建立在一個****自大的假設****上：認為他的方法自然就是最好的。

7. arrogant enough to...

= so self-important or overconfident that someone does something presumptuous

****自大到.....；傲慢到.....****

Examples

1. He was ****arrogant enough to dismiss everyone else's advice****.
他****自大到把所有人的建議都不放在眼裡****。
2. She was not ****arrogant enough to think she knew everything****.
她並沒有****自大到以為自己甚麼都知道****。

Social / interpersonal arrogance

8. arrogant toward someone

= behaving in a superior or dismissive way toward another person

****對某人傲慢；對某人擺出高姿態****

Examples

1. He was ****arrogant toward junior staff****.
他對資淺員工很****傲慢****。
2. She never behaved ****arrogantly toward students****.
她從不對學生****擺出高高在上的態度****。

Related forms

9. arrogance

= excessive belief in your own importance, ability, or superiority

傲慢；自大；自負

Examples

1. His **arrogance** made cooperation difficult.
他的**傲慢**讓合作變得困難。
2. Intelligence without humility can turn into **arrogance**.
聰明如果缺少謙遜，可能會變成**自大**。

Very relevant to the passage.

10. arrogantly

= in an arrogant way

傲慢地；自大地

Examples

1. He **arrogantly dismissed** the criticism.
他**傲慢地否定**了那些批評。
2. She never spoke **arrogantly** to students.
她從不**傲慢地**對學生說話。

Closely related forms / concepts

11. conceited

= having too high an opinion of your appearance, ability, or importance

自負的；自戀自大的

Examples

1. He is clever but rather **conceited**.

他很聰明，但有點**自負**。

2. She became **conceited** after receiving constant praise.

她一直受到稱讚後變得有些**自大**。

Not a morphological family member, but an important near-synonym.

12. self-important

= behaving as if you are more important than you really are

自以為重要的；自大的

Examples

1. He sounded rather **self-important**.

他聽起來相當**自以為是**。

2. She disliked people who acted **self-important**.

她不喜歡那些**擺出自以為很重要姿態**的人。

13. overconfident

= more confident than is justified by ability or evidence

過度自信的

Examples

1. He became **overconfident** after a few easy victories.

幾次輕鬆獲勝後，他變得**過度自信**。

2. Being **overconfident** can lead to poor decisions.

過度自信可能導致錯誤決定。

This overlaps with arrogance but is not the same.

High-value collocations

14. seem / sound arrogant

= give the impression of being arrogant

****顯得 / 聽起來很傲慢****

Examples

1. I don't want to ****sound arrogant****.

我不想讓自己****聽起來很自大****。

2. His answer ****seemed arrogant****.

他的回答****顯得很傲慢****。

15. come across as arrogant

= give others the impression that you are arrogant

****給人傲慢的感覺****

Examples

1. He sometimes ****comes across as arrogant**** because he speaks very directly.

他有時因為說話太直接，會****給人傲慢的感覺****。

2. Confidence can ****come across as arrogance**** if the tone is wrong.

如果語氣不對，自信可能會****被人理解成傲慢****。

16. arrogant and dismissive

= superior in attitude and unwilling to take others seriously

****傲慢而輕視別人的****

Examples

1. His response was ****arrogant and dismissive****.

他的回應既****傲慢又輕蔑****。

2. Good leaders should not become ****arrogant and dismissive****.

好的領導者不應變得****傲慢而不把別人當回事****。

Key contrasts

17. arrogant vs confident

This is the most important passage contrast.

****confident****

= believing in your ability in a healthy or justified way

**** 自信的 ****

****arrogant****

= believing or behaving as if you are superior to others

****傲慢的 ; 自大的****

Compare:

> She was ****confident**** in her knowledge.

> 她對自己的知識有自信。

> She was not ****arrogant**** about it.

> 她並沒有因此而自大。

A person can be very confident without being arrogant.

18. arrogant vs proud

****proud****

can be positive or neutral:

= pleased with an achievement, identity, or someone you care about

****自豪的 ; 驕傲的****

****arrogant****

is normally negative:

= acting superior to others

****傲慢的****

Compare:

> She was ****proud of her students****.

> 她為學生感到自豪。

> She was never ****arrogant toward her students****.

> 她從不對學生傲慢。

19. arrogant vs conceited

****conceited****

= having an excessively high opinion of yourself

****自負的；自戀自大的****

****arrogant****

= showing that sense of superiority in attitude or behavior

****傲慢的****

A conceited person thinks very highly of themselves; an arrogant person often behaves toward others as though superior.

They frequently overlap.

20. arrogant vs overconfident

****overconfident****

= more certain of your own success or ability than the evidence justifies

****過度自信的****

****arrogant****

= showing superiority toward others

****自大的；傲慢的****

Example:

A student can be ****overconfident**** about an exam without being arrogant toward anybody.

21. arrogant vs boastful

****boastful****

= frequently talking proudly about achievements or possessions

****愛吹噓的；愛自誇的****

****arrogant****

= broader attitude of superiority

Someone may be arrogant without openly boasting.

22. arrogant vs patronizing / condescending

****condescending / patronizing****

= speaking or behaving as though others are less intelligent or capable

****居高臨下的；以高人一等姿態對待人的****

****arrogant****

= broader belief/behavior of superiority

Compare:

> He was ****arrogant****.

> 他很自大。

> His explanation sounded ****condescending****.

> 他的解釋聽起來像把別人當笨蛋一樣居高臨下。

23. arrogant vs rude

****rude****

= impolite or disrespectful

****無禮的****

****arrogant****

= superior and self-important

****傲慢的****

Arrogance can cause rude behavior, but not all rude behavior comes from arrogance.

24. arrogant vs assertive

****assertive****

= expressing your needs or opinions clearly and confidently while respecting others

****堅定自信的；敢於表達的****

****arrogant****

= asserting superiority over others

****傲慢的****

This distinction is very important for learners:

> assertive ≠ arrogant

Passage contrast: humility vs arrogance

25. humility vs arrogance

****humility****

= recognizing your strengths and limitations without putting yourself above others

****謙遜****

****arrogance****

= treating yourself as superior or more important than others

****傲慢****

The passage describes Ms. Lau as:

> knowledgeable

> sharp

> confident

> humble

but ****not arrogant****.

That combination is central to the speaker's admiration.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****arrogant**** is:

****an exaggerated sense of superiority that shows in how someone thinks or behaves toward others****

From this develop:

Person

an arrogant person

→ ****傲慢的人****

Attitude

arrogant attitude

→ ****高高在上的態度****

Speech

arrogant tone

→ **盛氣凌人的語氣**

Judgment

arrogant assumption

→ **自以為是的假設**

Family

arrogance

→ **傲慢；自大**

arrogantly

→ **傲慢地**

Unlike highly polysemous words such as **field**, **command**, or **shadow**, **arrogant** has one strong semantic core. The main learner challenge is not sense separation but distinguishing it accurately from nearby concepts such as **confidence**, **pride**, **overconfidence**, and **assertiveness**.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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arrogant — person	認為自己比別人更重要、更聰明或更優秀，並表現出優越感；傲慢的 / 自大的
arrogant attitude/manner	表現出高人一等、看不起別人的態度 / 舉止
arrogant tone	說話時帶有優越感、輕視或盛氣凌人的語氣
arrogant assumption	因過度相信自己的優越性或判斷而作出的自以為是假設
arrogant toward someone	對某人表現得高高在上、不把對方當一回事
seem/sound arrogant	給人 / 聽起來有自大、傲慢的印象
come across as arrogant	無論本意如何，給別人留下傲慢的印象
arrogance	認為自己高人一等並因此自大的態度；傲慢 / 自負
arrogantly	以高高在上、自大的方式
conceited	對自己的能力、外貌或重要性有過高評價；自負的
self-important	表現得彷彿自己比實際上重要得多；自以為是的
overconfident	對自己的能力或成功把握超過實際依據；過度自信的

Passage recap

> “She was sharp without being **arrogant**...”

Here:

arrogant = behaving as if you are superior to other people because of your intelligence, ability, status, or confidence

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **傲慢的**

* **自大的**

* **自以為是的**

* contextually: **聰明卻不會擺出高人一等的姿態**

Natural contextual translation:

她很聰明敏銳，卻一點也不傲慢。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

arrogant

= having or showing an exaggerated belief that you are better, more important, or more capable than others

傲慢的；自大的；自以為是的

The key distinction is:

> **confident**

> → 我知道自己有能力。

> **arrogant**

> → 我認為自己比別人高一等。

And:

> **humble**

> → 我知道自己的能力，但也知道自己並非無所不知，也不把自己置於別人之上。

That is precisely why the passage’s phrase **“sharp without being arrogant”** works so well.